

README File for Replication Data for “How Do You Say Your Name? Difficult-To-Pronounce Names and Labor Market Outcomes”

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Abstract

This README file describes the data and code used to replicate the tables in the main text

Key Summary of the Replication Code

1. **Software and Execution:** This replication package is designed to be executed using **Stata**. After updating the root directory to your local file path, the script will run automatically to generate all tables (excluding Table 5) presented in the main text.
2. **Replicability of Table 5:** Please note that **Table 5 cannot be replicated** using the provided code. The original replication package **does not include a specific script** for this table, as it was constructed by synthesizing findings from two other prior studies. This limitation is explicitly documented in the original README file. **Therefore, a manually formatted version of Table 5 is already provided in the tables/ folder.**
3. **Output Table Formatting:** The results for **Tables 2, 3, 4, 8, and 9** are split across two separate output files. These divisions may occur:
 - **Horizontally:** e.g., Columns 1–4 in the first file and Columns 5–6 in the second.
 - **Vertically:** Split into top and bottom panels.

However, the combined results from these files are fully consistent with the final tables published in the paper.

1 File Structure

This replication package contains the necessary data and code to generate the 9 tables presented in the main text.

The file structure is as follows. The main folder contains five subfolders:

- **data:** contains the analysis data created by the master do-file.

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- **do-file:** contains the individual Stata do-files called by the master.do file that will construct the analysis data and perform the analysis.
- **logs:** contains the corresponding Stata log-files.
- **raw_data:** contains the raw data sets used to produce the analysis data.
- **tables:** contain the analysis output reported in the main text.

2 Data Availability and Provenance Statements

2.1 Statement about Rights

- We certify that the authors of the manuscript have legitimate access to and permission to use the data used in this manuscript.
- We certify that the authors of the manuscript have documented permission to redistribute/publish the data contained within this replication package.

2.2 Summary of Availability

- All data are publicly available.

2.3 List of Data Sets and Data Description

We describe below the sources of the observational and experimental data employed in this study. The raw data sets are in Stata .dta format and are located in the **raw_data/** folder.

I. Observational data on economics PhD job market candidates' characteristics and placement outcomes from Ge et al. (2021a) (JMC_raw.dta)

- This data is used in Ge et al. (2021b), and we have been given permission to republish it in the replication package. The relevant information is obtained from publicly available departmental web pages that list placement histories of their graduates. See Section I.A of the paper (Economics PhD Job Market Candidates) for detailed description of the data. Each candidate is uniquely identified by the variable **JMC_id**.

II. Data on economics PhD job market candidates' name fluency in Ge et al. (2021b) (JMC-pronounce.dta)

- This data contains three different ways to measure a job market candidate's (first and last) name fluency, including a computer-generated algorithm that assesses the difficulty of pronouncing various words, a rating based on the median time it takes a team of research assistants to pronounce a particular name, and a subjective measure based on three independent raters. See Section I.B of the paper (Name Fluency Ratings) for detailed descriptions of each method. Each candidate is uniquely identified by **JMC_id**.

III. Experimental data from Bertrand and Mullainathan (2019) (lakisha_aer.dta)

- The publicly available replication data for Bertrand and Mullainathan (2004) can be accessed at See Section III of the paper (Experimental Data from Prior Audit Studies) for a detailed description of the data.

IV. Data on job applicants' first name fluency in Bertrand and Mullainathan (2004)
(BM-pronounce.dta)

- This data contains the algorithm rating of each job applicant's first name used in Bertrand and Mullainathan (2004). Note that the publicly available data set for Bertrand and Mullainathan (2004) contains first names but not last names, so the algorithm ratings are therefore limited to first names as well.

V. Experimental data from Oreopoulos (2019)

(oreopoulos-resume-study-replication-data-file.dta)

- The publicly available replication data for Oreopoulos (2011) can be accessed at <https://doi.org/10.3886/E114770V1>. See Section III of the paper (Experimental Data from Prior Audit Studies) for a detailed description of the data.

VI. Data on job applicants' first name fluency in Oreopoulos (2011) (Oreop_first_pronounce.dta)

- This data contains the algorithm rating of each job applicant's first name used in Oreopoulos (2011).

VII. Data on job applicants' last name fluency in Oreopoulos (2011) (Oreop_last_pronounce.dta)

- This data contains the algorithm rating of each job applicant's last name used in Oreopoulos (2011).

VIII. Experimental data from Nunley et al. (2015a) (bejeap_deidentified_data.dta)

- The replication data for Nunley et al. (2015b) are provided by the authors of Nunley et al. (2015b), and we have been given permission to republish the data in the replication package.

IX. Data on job applicants' last name fluency in Nunley et al. (2015b) (NunleyEtAl_pronounce.dta)

- This data contains the algorithm rating of each job applicant's first and last names used in Nunley et al. (2015b).

3 Computational Requirements

The code and data must be executed using Stata. The replication code also uses two user-written programs, `outreg2` and `estout`, both of which need to be installed via `config.do`. The code was last run using Stata 17 SE on Windows 11 Pro. Computation time took 1 minute and 23 seconds.

4 Description of Replication Code

Instructions for running the replication code are as follows.

- I. Download and unzip the replication archive.
- II. Set the root directory "[[location of replication archive]]" in `master.do` to the file path pointing to the location of the downloaded and unzipped replication archive.

III. Execute `master.do` in Stata which will first run a separate do-file called `config.do` that installs the necessary user-written programs (`outreg2` and `estout`). The master do-file will then invoke all the do-files nested in the `do-file/` subfolder in the following order.

a) **Data preparation:**

- 1) `prep_JMC.do` – This prepares the data on economics PhD job market candidates’ characteristics and placement outcomes from Ge et al. (2021a) and merge it with measures on candidates’ name fluency;
- 2) `prep_BM.do` – This prepares the data from Bertrand and Mullainathan (2019) and merges it with measures of job applicants’ name fluency;
- 3) `prep_Oreopoulos.do` – This prepares the data from Oreopoulos (2019) and merges it with measures of job applicants’ name fluency;
- 4) `prep_BM_Oreop_pooled.do` – This stacks the data from Bertrand and Mullainathan (2019) and Oreopoulos (2019) for the combined audit study analysis.
- 5) `prep_NunleyEtAl.do` – This prepares the data from Nunley et al. (2015a) and merges it with measures of job applicants’ name fluency.

b) **Processed analysis data files** will be saved in Stata `.dta` format under the `data/` subfolder. These files include:

- 1) `JMC.dta`: necessary for generating Tables 1–4 and A1–A10;
- 2) `BM.dta`: necessary for generating Tables 5, 6, 8, A11, A12, A15, and A16;
- 3) `Oreopoulos.dta`: necessary for generating Tables 5, 7, 8, A11, A13, A14, A15, and A16;
- 4) `BM_Oreop_pooled.dta`: necessary for generating Tables 9 and A16;
- 5) `NunleyEtAl.dta`: necessary for generating Table A17.

c) **Separate do-files** will perform the analysis and replicate the results presented in each table,[†] including:

- 1) `Table1.do` – Table 1: Sample of Economics PhD Job Candidates: Summary Statistics;
- 2) `Table2.do` – Table 2: Name Fluency and Placement Outcomes: Algorithm Rating;
- 3) `Table3.do` – Table 3: Name Fluency and Placement Outcomes: Pronunciation Time and Subjective Rating;
- 4) `Table4.do` – Table 4: Name Fluency and Placement Outcomes by Program Rankings;
- 5) `Table6.do` – Table 6: Name Fluency and Callback Rates: Experimental Data from Bertrand and Mullainathan (2004);
- 6) `Table7.do` – Table 7: Name Fluency and Callback Rates: Experimental Data from Oreopoulos (2011);
- 7) `Table8.do` – Table 8: Name Fluency and Callback Rates by Resume Quality: Experimental Data from Bertrand and Mullainathan (2004) and Oreopoulos (2011);
- 8) `Table9.do` – Table 9: Name Fluency and Callback Rates: Combining Experimental Data from Bertrand and Mullainathan (2004) and Oreopoulos (2011);

The output tables will be saved in L^AT_EX `.tex` format under the `tables/` subfolder for main text tables.

[†]Note that different operating systems and Stata versions could result in minor numerical discrepancies in the probit results presented in Tables 4 and A7.

References

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